

Nielsen Norman Group

Heuristic Evaluation

Workbook

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

<https://www.nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics/>

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Evaluator:
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Date: May
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Product:
GICT-
TRANSLINK

Task: To
see the
bus
schedule
and the
incoming
bus

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1



Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state? Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?
-

Issues

While toast notifications exist for successful actions, there is no visual indicator for processing states during transactions.

Recommendations

Add a loading spinner or progress bar immediately after a user clicks “Proceed to Payment” to show that the system is working.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design? Do the design's
- controls follow real-world conventions?
 -

Issues

The seat selection grid shows numbers but lacks real-world spatial context orientation.

Recommendations

Add a visual anchor (like a steering wheel icon) to indicate the front of the bus so users easily understand the seating layout direction.

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action? Is
- *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

Multi-step booking screens rely heavily on back arrows, lacking a quick way to completely abort the process.

Recommendations

Include a prominent "Cancel Booking" or "Close (X)" button on checkout and payment screens to let users instantly return to the homepage.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

Minor visual variations exist between button styles and header blues across the web landing page and the mobile checkout screens.

Recommendations

Standardize the primary blue color hex code and button corner radiuses across both platforms to maintain a unified brand identity.

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Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

Text fields and generic date selectors leave room for accidental, invalid selections (like picking a past date).

Recommendations

Gray out and completely disable past dates and times in the scheduling components so they cannot be selected at all.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

Once users advance to the final payment summary screens, some of their original trip selections are hidden.

Recommendations

Keep a persistent, compact summary block (Origin \rightarrow Destination, Date, Seat Number) visible throughout the entire checkout process.

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Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

The system is built linearly for first-time users, offering no shortcuts or accelerators for frequent travelers.

Recommendations

Introduce a “Favorite Routes” or “Quick Rebook Last Trip” button on the dashboard to streamline booking for daily commuters.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

The landing page “Feature Cards” and text elements are slightly crowded, which might reduce readability on smaller screens.

Recommendations

Increase padding and whitespace around the card borders and text blocks to make the layout feel more open and scannable.

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Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues	Recommendations
There are no dedicated mockups or visual paths showing how the system handles input errors or failed transactions.	Design clear error UI states using standard red indicators, accompanied by actionable copy (e.g., “Network error. Tap here to retry payment”).

10 Help and

Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation.

However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues	Recommendations
Support options are currently confined to the landing page, making them hard to reach mid-transaction.	[Grab your reader's attention with a great quote from the document or use this space to emphasize a key point. To place this text box anywhere on the page, just drag it.]